

DARK MECHANICUM

THE HERETEK CYBERTHEURGY

MECHANICUM (HH) • HETERODOX • TRAITOR

“The Omnissiah is dead. The Machine God is older, hungrier, and listens to those who would feed it.” — Archmagos Kelbor-Hal, Fabricator-General of Mars, Opening Speech of the Schism of Mars, 004.M31. The Dark Mechanicum are those Magos who saw the warp’s whisper as opportunity — who traded the sacred algorithms for forbidden science, and stitched daemon-souls into their war engines.

FACTION ABILITY — DOCTRINA IMPERATIVES

*At the start of your Command phase, select one of the two Doctrina Imperatives below. Until the start of your next Command phase, every **Mechanicum (HH)** model in your army gains the effect of the chosen Imperative. You cannot select the same Imperative in two consecutive Command phases. Heterodox cogitations still respond to the old patterns, though the binary catechism has been replaced with daemonic verse.*

Conqueror Imperative

Each time a model with this Imperative makes an attack (ranged or melee), an unmodified Hit roll of 6 scores one additional Hit.

Protector Imperative

Each time an attack is made against a unit with this Imperative, subtract 1 from the Hit roll.

DETACHMENT RULE — HERETEK CYBERTHEURGY

Heretek Cybertheurgy

The Dark Mechanicum trades the Omnissiah’s sacred algorithms for the warp’s forbidden whisper. Every shot is a prayer; every prayer demands a price.

Each time a friendly **Mechanicum (Heterodox)** unit makes an attack, you may invoke *Heretek Cybertheurgy*: until the end of the phase, attacks made by that unit gain the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability. After resolving that unit’s attacks, roll one D6: on a 1 or 2, *the warp price is paid* — one model in the unit (your choice) suffers 1 mortal wound. A unit may only invoke this rule once per phase.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

✓ **Included:** All canonical Mechanicum (Taghmata) units, all Skitarii Conclaves units, all Questoris Familia Knights (treated as Renegade Knights for narrative purposes). Standard Mechanicum characters (Archmagos, Magos, Tech-Priest, and their on-Abeyant variants).

+ **Heterodox-Only Additions:** **Anacharis Scoria** (Heretek Archmagos), **Archmagos Draykavac**, and the Heterodox daemon engines: **Blood Slaughterer**, **Brass Scorpion**, **Kytan Daemon Engine**, **Decimator**. These are the units the Loyalist detachment cannot take.

ENHANCEMENTS

Cursed Cogitation 20 pts

The bearer’s logic engines whisper with daemonic murmurs — each calculation tinged with the warp’s malice.

While the bearer is leading a unit, each time a model in that unit makes an attack, an unmodified Wound roll of 6 inflicts 1 mortal wound on the target unit in addition to any normal damage.

Mark of Chaos Undivided 25 pts

The bearer is favoured by the Eight. The Chaos powers find Heretek Magos useful, and they pay well for that usefulness.

The bearer gains a 4+ Invulnerable save (if it has a worse one). In addition, once per battle round, the first time the bearer would lose a wound, that wound is ignored (treat it as not having occurred).

Daemonic Symbiote 20 pts

A warp-spawned parasite has bonded with the bearer's nervous system — it gnaws at the soul, but it also closes wounds and whispers tactical foresight.

At the start of each of your Command phases, the bearer regains up to D3 lost wounds. In addition, the bearer's melee weapons gain the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

Heretek Augmetics 15 pts

The bearer has replaced sacred Mechanicus organs with corrupted Heretek variants — servos that scream, neural lace that hisses, blade-arms that hunger.

Add 2 to the bearer's Attacks characteristic, and the bearer's melee weapons gain +1 to the Strength characteristic.

STRATAGEMS

Warp-Tainted Volley 1 CP

Dark Mechanicum — Battle Tactic Stratagem

The ammunition has been daemon-blessed; the shells scream as they fly, and the wounds they leave do not close.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Heterodox Mechanicum unit is selected to shoot.

TARGET: That unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, attacks made by models in this unit have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability. *After this unit has resolved its attacks, the unit suffers 1 mortal wound (the warp price).*

Cybertheurgical Hex 1 CP

Dark Mechanicum — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The Heretek's binary cant invokes a glitch in the foe's logic-systems — eyes, scopes, and auto-senses falter for a heartbeat.

WHEN: Start of any of your opponent's phases.

TARGET: One enemy unit within 18" of a friendly Heterodox Mechanicum unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of that phase, attacks made by models in the target unit subtract 1 from the Hit roll.

Forbidden Tech 1 CP

Dark Mechanicum — Battle Tactic Stratagem

The reactor surges past safe tolerances; the chassis trembles with stolen power.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Heterodox Mechanicum **Vehicle** or **Walker** is selected to shoot.

TARGET: That unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, ranged weapons equipped by models in this unit have +1 to the Strength characteristic and +1 to the Wound roll.

Brass-Forged Hunger 2 CP

Dark Mechanicum — Battle Tactic Stratagem

Khorne's daemon engines do not tire; the brass thirsts, and the blood is sweet.

WHEN: Your Fight phase, just after a friendly Heterodox Mechanicum **Daemon Engine** or **Vehicle** is selected to fight.

TARGET: That unit.

EFFECT: Models in this unit make their melee attacks twice this phase (resolve each set of attacks separately and in full). *After the second set of attacks resolves, the unit suffers D3 mortal wounds.*

Allegiance to the Eight 1 CP

Dark Mechanicum — Epic Deed Stratagem

The Heretek pledges anew; the warp answers with stolen muscle and unfeeling resolve.

WHEN: Your Command phase.

TARGET: One friendly Heterodox **Character**.
EFFECT: Until your next Command phase, the Character has +1 Toughness, +1 Wound, and its melee attacks gain the [SUSTAINED HITS 1] ability.

Daemonic Possession 1 CP

Dark Mechanicum — Strategic Ploy Stratagem
The daemon takes the wheel. For a brief, dreadful moment, the war machine does not need a driver.

WHEN: Your Command phase.
TARGET: One friendly Heterodox **Vehicle** or **Daemon Engine** unit.
EFFECT: Until your next Command phase, the unit has the Feel No Pain 5+ ability, automatically passes Battle-shock tests, and ignores rules that would force it to Fall Back. *At the start of your following Command phase, the unit suffers D3 mortal wounds as the daemon strains the chassis.*

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2022) Mechanicum → 10e 40K conversion. Dark Mechanicum is the Heterodox faction that sided with Horus — Kelbor-Hal's bloc, the Magos who saw the warp's whisper as a path to forbidden knowledge. This detachment uses the same Doctrina Imperatives faction ability as Taghmata Ommissiah (the cogitations are still Mechanicum, even if the catechism is now daemonic). The Heretek Cybertheurgy detachment rule trades reliable [LETHAL HITS] for unreliable [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] with a built-in chance of self-damage — the warp price. Enhancements lean into damage scaling and survivability through symbiotic warp-craft; stratagems all carry an optional warp cost (mortal wounds to your own unit) reflecting that every heretek prayer demands payment. Composition adds the four iconic Heterodox-locked daemon engines (Blood Slaughterer, Brass Scorpion, Kytan, Decimator) and the two iconic Heretek characters (Anacharis Scoria, Archmagos Draykavac) on top of the shared Mechanicum roster. The army loses Sacred Algorithms but gains daemon-tier hammer-units and faster-burning aggression.

DETACHMENT KEYWORDS
Dark Mechanicum • Heterodox • Mechanicum (HH) • Traitor • Chaos